

INDUSTRY TREND ANALYSIS

Energy security becomes a permanent strategy setting

Structural · Evidence current to 27 August 2026

The signal

Power availability, affordability, volatility, and geopolitical exposure now shape industrial, digital, and national investment choices.

2.5% World Bank forecast for global growth in 2026, down from 2.9% in 2025 amid energy and geopolitical shocks. ^[1]	\$3.4 trillion IEA forecast for 2026 energy investment as resilience and diversification rise in importance. ^[2]	600 million people in Africa described in the Weekly Brief archive as still lacking electricity. ^[3]
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What is changing - and why it matters

Energy security is now a permanent input to industrial, digital and national strategy. Price, availability, import exposure and infrastructure resilience affect location and capital decisions. The external outlook shows that conflict can slow growth and trade, while the Brief archive shows energy becoming central to AI, infrastructure and emerging-market development. Security and transition cannot be planned separately.

Executive implication

Energy security is now a permanent input to industrial, digital and national strategy. Price, availability, import exposure and infrastructure resilience affect location and capital decisions. The external outlook shows that conflict can slow growth and trade, while the Brief archive shows energy becoming central to AI, infrastructure and emerging-market development. Security and transition cannot be planned separately.

Action agenda

- Quantify earnings exposure to price, supply and grid scenarios.
- Diversify supply and increase operational flexibility where economics justify it.
- Integrate energy security into market-entry, digital-capacity and manufacturing decisions.

What could change the view

- A prolonged supply shock embeds structurally higher transport and fuel costs.
- Security responses delay transition assets without building durable alternatives.

Selected evidence

[1] Authoritative research · World Bank · 2026-06-16 · Global Economic Prospects — June 2026 · p. 25

[2] Authoritative research · IEA · 2026-05-28 · World Energy Investment 2026 · p. 6

[3] Weekly Brief · 2023-11-07 · The Youthful Promise of Africa

[4] Weekly Brief · 2023-09-06 · A Blueprint for the Energy Transition

[5] Weekly Brief · 2025-01-14 · Navigating the New Dynamics of Global Trade

[6] Authoritative research · J.P. Morgan Global Research · 2026-07-01 · Mid-Year Market Outlook 2026: The Tug of War Continues

This independent analysis connects the available Weekly Brief archive with selected authoritative research. Forecasts and company-reported figures are identified in context. The complete evidence list remains available on the website.